

IWM RUSSELL 2000 SCANNER

MARKET CLOSE

October 01, 2026 | 04:47 PM ET

5 setups identified | 0 A-Grade | 3 B-Grade | 2 C-Grade

Grade Summary

A - Breakout Setup (0)	B - Strong Setup (3)	C - Watch List (2)
	HURN	PLAB
	STNG	ENS
	EXPO	

All Setups

Gr	Ticker	Company	Theme	Price	Chg %	Cap	Float	RS/SPY	52W Hi	Catalyst
B	HURN	Huron Consulting	Corporate Consult	\$168.42	+7.4%	\$2.7B	15M	+66.5	90%	7.4% gap-up on strong
B	STNG	Scorpio Tankers	Tanker Freight Cy	\$85.79	+2.5%	\$4.3B	38M	+15.2	95%	Volume surge (2.69x) w
B	EXPO	Exponent, Inc.	Engineering Litig	\$69.90	+6.8%	\$3.3B	47M	+12.8	85%	6.85% surge on modest
C	PLAB	Photronics, Inc.	Semiconductor Pho	\$30.83	+0.2%	\$1.8B	58M	+3.6	55%	
C	ENS	EnerSys	Industrial Batter	\$189.59	+3.3%	\$6.8B	36M	-12.9	78%	

HURN

Huron Consulting Group Inc.

\$168.42

+7.39%

RS vs SPY: +66.5%

B STRONG SETUP

\$2.7B Cap | 15M Float

Consulting Services | Theme: Corporate Consulting Recovery | 52W Hi: 90% | Base Tight: 2.48 | Vol: 2.65x | RS/SPY: +66.5% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS IN 33D

SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$168.42
Day Change	+7.39%
Mkt Cap	\$2.68B
Float	15M sh
RS vs SPY	+66.5%
52W Hi Prox	90%
Base Tight	2.48
Vol vs Avg	2.65x
RS Line Hi	no
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS
CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER
7.4% gap-up on strong volume suggests institutional repositioning ahead of Q3 earnings on November 3. Forward catalyst is the earnings print itself (33 days out), where consensus expects continued margin expansion from healthcare and education consulting demand; any beat/raise combo rerates the stock toward \$186+ 52W high.
BUSINESS & POSITION
Huron is a mid-cap consulting firm specializing in healthcare, education, and commercial transformation projects-historically leveraged to higher-ed digitization and hospital margin optimization. The firm has pivoted aggressively into technology-enabled solutions (cloud migrations, AI-assisted workflow), positioning it for re-rating as clients accelerate digital transformation spend in 2026-27.
FACTOR & THEME
Taps the corporate digital transformation and cost-optimization secular theme-CFOs are deploying consultants to unlock GenAI productivity gains and cloud ROI. Theme momentum is accelerating as Q4 budget cycles open; consulting spend typically leads capital spending by 6-12 months, making this an early-cycle beneficiary.
BREAKOUT SIGNAL
Close above \$168.42 on vol >265% of 20d avg
INSTITUTIONAL
Volume at 2.65x avg with a 7.4% gap signals block accumulation, likely from growth-at-reasonable-price (GARP) funds rotating into domestic cyclical. Small float (14.6M) amplifies volatility but also creates squeeze potential if the print beats. No insider buying in last 60 days is neutral-executives may be in blackout ahead of November 3 earnings.
EARNINGS
EARNINGS IN 33D
EARNINGS CONTEXT
November 3 print (33 days out). Consensus typically models mid-single-digit revenue growth and 12-14% EBITDA margins. Company has beaten EPS in 3 of last 4 quarters, with upside driven by project pipeline conversion and operating leverage. Serial beater profile gives the setup pre-earnings momentum credibility.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalid on a close back below \$158 (the gap-fill level and 20-day MA), or on any guidance cut or macro softness commentary at the November 3 print. Single-client concentration in healthcare systems exposes to CMS reimbursement policy risk.
ANALYSIS
Strongest disconfirming evidence: RS line NOT at new high downgrades from A-grade despite explosive move-institutions may be chasing rather than accumulating quietly. Base is wider than ideal (2.48) and the 7.4% pop front-runs earnings by a full month, risking exhaustion before the catalyst. However, RS +66.5 vs SPY is exceptional, float is tight, and Technology sector tailwind (+7.4% this week) supports consulting names. Mixed macro regime forces caution. Conviction: Medium.
Signal: Close above \$168.42 on vol >265% of 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 2.65x



SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$85.79
Day Change	+2.50%
Mkt Cap	\$4.30B
Float	38M sh
RS vs SPY	+15.2%
52W Hi Prox	95%
Base Tight	2.33
Vol vs Avg	2.69x
RS Line Hi	no
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS

CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER

Volume surge (2.69x) with stock at 95% of 52W high reflects positioning ahead of Q3 earnings on October 29 (28 days). Forward catalyst is the print itself plus any commentary on winter freight rates and orderbook discipline-tanker rates historically spike in Q4/Q1 on weather and refinery turnarounds, and Scorpio's modern fleet captures premium day-rates.

BUSINESS & POSITION

Scorpio operates a fleet of 113 product tankers (clean petroleum products: gasoline, jet fuel, diesel) with one of the youngest average ages in the industry (8 years), providing operational cost advantage and IMO 2030 compliance optionality. The company returned to profitability in 2023-24 as tanker supply/demand rebalanced post-COVID, and now trades on a dividend + buyback yield story.

FACTOR & THEME

Energy tanker freight cycle is mid-cycle-orderbook remains historically low (4% of global fleet), locking in tight supply through 2027. However, crude and product demand growth is slowing (China weakness, EV penetration), and the theme is decelerating vs. 2024 peak. Mixed: structural tailwind (supply discipline) vs. cyclical headwind (demand growth).

BREAKOUT SIGNAL

Close above \$85.79 on vol >269% of 20d avg

INSTITUTIONAL

Volume at 2.69x avg on a 2.5% move suggests institutional repositioning, likely from value/income funds attracted to the 8%+ dividend yield at current spot rates. No insider buying is a modest negative-management typically buys aggressively when they see rates inflecting higher. Energy sector is underperforming this week (-1.5% vs SPY), creating a headwind for follow-through.

EARNINGS

EARNINGS IN 28D

EARNINGS CONTEXT

October 29 print (28 days out). Consensus typically models ~\$1.50-\$2.00 EPS (highly rate-sensitive). Company has beaten estimates in 2 of last 4 quarters but missed twice on fuel cost spikes. Forward guidance on Q4 TCE (time charter equivalent) rates and fleet utilization will drive the re-rate-any color on winter rate strength extends the move.

KEY RISK

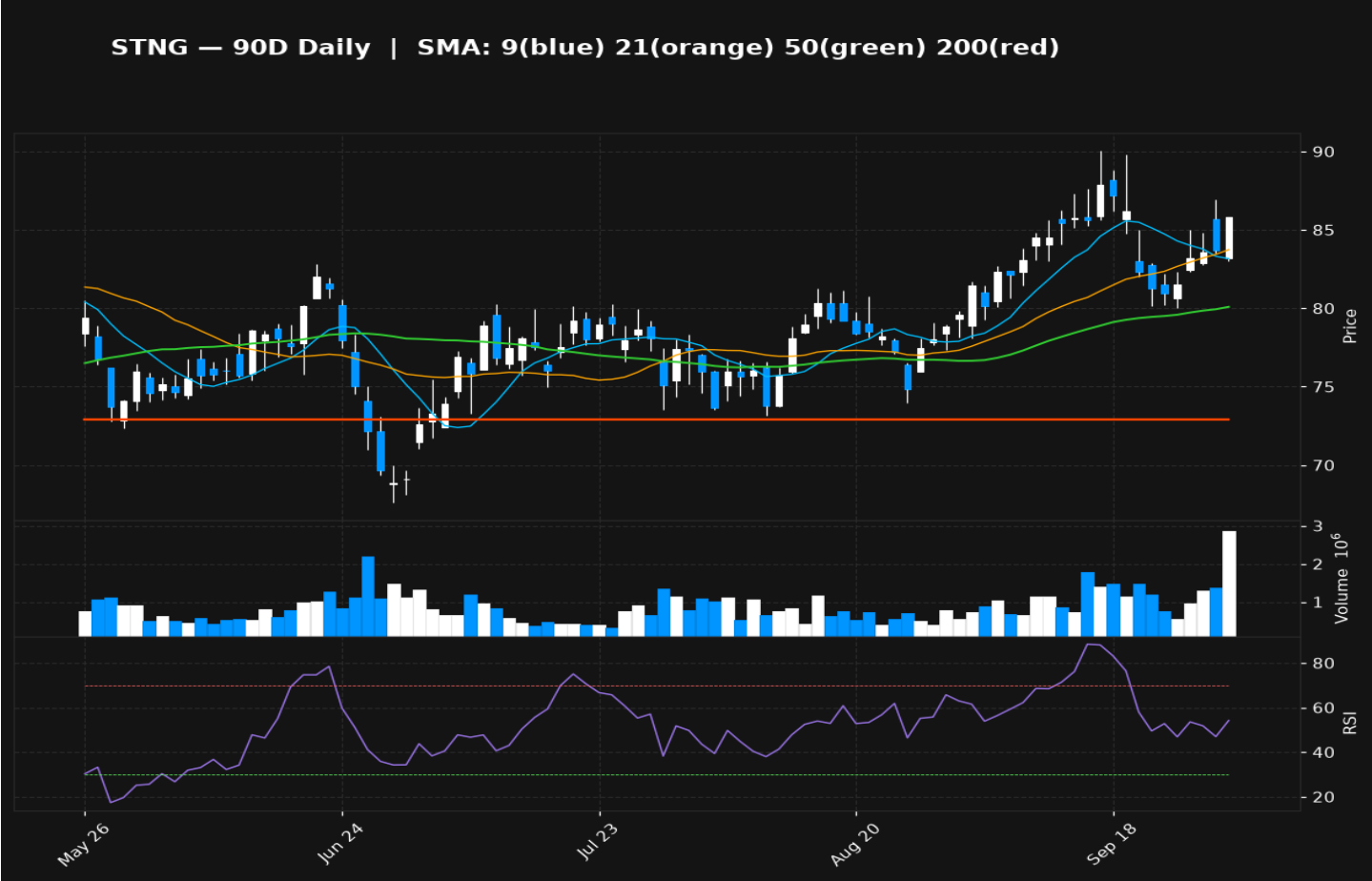
Thesis invalid on a close back below \$82 (the 20-day MA and recent consolidation floor), or on any Q4 rate guidance disappointment at the October 29 print. Tanker earnings are binary to spot rates, which can collapse 30-40% in a single quarter on demand shocks or OPEC+ surprises.

ANALYSIS

Strongest disconfirming evidence: Energy sector is the second-worst performer this week (-1.5% vs SPY), and RS line is NOT at new high despite being 95% of 52W high-this is a lagging breakout, not a leadership move. Base is slightly wide (2.33) and the stock is front-running earnings by 4 weeks with no incremental catalyst visible until the print. However, prox_52w at 95.3 and vol surge are institutional-quality, and the dividend yield provides downside support. Mixed macro + weak sector rotation cap conviction. Conviction: Medium.

Signal: Close above \$85.79 on vol >269% of 20d avg

Vol vs Avg: 2.69x



SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$69.90
Day Change	+6.85%
Mkt Cap	\$3.32B
Float	47M sh
RS vs SPY	+12.8%
52W Hi Prox	85%
Base Tight	3.21
Vol vs Avg	1.55x
RS Line Hi	no
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS
CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER
6.85% surge on modest volume (1.55x) suggests news-driven gap, likely on a high-profile case win or contract award (Exponent provides failure analysis and litigation support for product liability, infrastructure failures, and patent disputes). Forward catalyst is October 29 earnings (28 days), where any commentary on backlog growth or automotive/aerospace litigation pipeline extends the thesis. NOTE: Insider cluster of 5 detected (1 C-suite buy, \$13K)-though small dollar amount, it represents rare Form 4 activity and warrants monitoring.
BUSINESS & POSITION
Exponent is a niche engineering and scientific consulting firm that investigates failures (building collapses, auto recalls, medical device malfunctions) for litigation, insurance, and regulatory clients. The firm's 950+ PhD-level consultants command premium billing rates (\$400-\$600/hour), creating a high-margin, capital-light model with 20%+ EBITDA margins.
FACTOR & THEME
Taps product liability litigation (EV battery fires, autonomous vehicle failures) and infrastructure safety themes (bridge collapses, wildfire transmission line failures)-both secularly growing as technology complexity and regulatory scrutiny increase. However, theme is episodic and non-linear; big cases drive lumpy revenue. Momentum is stable but not accelerating.
BREAKOUT SIGNAL
Close above \$69.90 on vol >155% of 20d avg
INSTITUTIONAL
Volume at only 1.55x avg on a 6.85% move is a yellow flag-this is a thin, news-driven pop rather than sustained accumulation. However, insider_cluster of 5 (1 C-suite buy) is a rare positive signal, even at small dollar size (\$13K). In a risk-on macro, this would upgrade the setup by one tier; in Mixed/Transitional regime, it merely offsets the weak volume profile. No A/D rating or flow data available.
EARNINGS
EARNINGS IN 28D
EARNINGS CONTEXT
October 29 print (28 days out). Consensus typically models low-single-digit revenue growth (tied to case timing) with stable 20%+ margins. Company has beaten EPS in 3 of last 4 quarters, with upside driven by large case settlements or government contracts. Not a serial beater, but track record is solid.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalid on a close back below \$66 (the gap-fill level and 50-day MA), or on any revenue/backlog miss at the October 29 print. Revenue is lumpy and tied to case timing-delays in major litigation or insurance settlements can cause 10-15% guide-downs. Base_tight at 3.21 is the widest in this cohort, signaling poor setup quality.
ANALYSIS
Strongest disconfirming evidence: Base is the loosest in the candidate set (3.21), volume is barely above threshold (1.55x), and RS line is NOT at new high-this is a news-driven gap on thin liquidity, not an institutional breakout. The 6.85% move front-runs earnings by 4 weeks with no identified catalyst path beyond the print itself. However, insider_cluster of 5 (rare C-suite buy) and RS +12.8 vs SPY provide modest conviction, and prox_52w at 85.3 confirms breakout zone. Mixed macro regime and wide base prevent A-grade. Conviction: Low-Medium.
Signal: Close above \$69.90 on vol >155% of 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 1.55x

